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IN A CERTAIN LIGHT

The New England sky remained shrouded in smoke Wednesday from wildfires in Canada and Minnesota, conditions that are expected to last through Friday. Top: The water at Crystal Lake in Newton took on the same yellowish hue as the sky on Wednesday. The sun appeared as an orange ball above the steeple at the First Congregational Church in Hanover. **B1.**

Familiar cloud follows shooting

Frustration mounts as ICE gives conflicting accounts

By Anjali Huynh and Tal Kopan
GLOBE STAFF

The fatal shooting of an immigrant in Maine on Monday by an ICE agent fits what lawmakers and advocates say is an emerging pattern by the embattled agency: a violent confrontation with a person who was not the target of their operation and conflicting explanations about how it unfolded — if any at all.

Immigration and Customs Enforcement agents on Monday shot into a car driven by Johan Sebastián Durán Guerrero, a 26-year-old Colombian native who was legally authorized to work in the United States and whom neighbors described as trying to build a stable life for his family.

After initially claiming they were acting on a deportation order, the agency later admitted that Guerrero was not the target of the operation, although details of what happened are still murky.

The fatal shooting, coming shortly after another in Texas, has intensified scrutiny of the Trump administration's immigration tactics, as well as complaints about shifting explanations and little transparency.

The situation prompted at least one immediate response from ICE. **Page A7**

Witness says victim told agents: 'I tried to stop!'

Answers scarce, tensions high in Maine community

By Shannon Larson and
Giulia McDonnell Nieto del Rio
GLOBE STAFF

"I tried to stop!"

Those were the words a Biddeford, Maine, resident said he heard Johan Sebastián Durán Guerrero shout after federal immigration agents dragged him out of his white sedan and onto the ground, his face streaked red with blood.

The witness, a 71-year-old named Daniel Boucher, said he was in his apartment early Monday morning when he first heard gunshots, believing them to be fireworks. He leaned out his front door and he watched in horror at the scene unfolding just outside his building.

Within moments, Guerrero appeared to stop breathing. His stomach was still, his legs motionless, Boucher said.

"I was shaking and crying," he said. "Just tragic, sad, absolutely awful. Totally needless."

Two days after Guerrero was shot to death by ICE agents, the Biddeford area remained tense as residents and Maine officials continued to criticize as well as call for more information from the federal agency. **BIDDEFORD, Page A7**

The fate of Todd Blanche's nomination as attorney general remained uncertain after a rocky confirmation hearing. **A2.**

The United States reimposed a naval blockade on Iran and intensified its air-strike campaign. **A4.**

Governor Maura Healey filed legislation to send an extra infusion of money to local school districts in the wake of a difficult budget season. **B1.**

Walden Robotics revealed it raised \$300 million to build a line of AI-powered, partially humanoid machines. **D1.**

Argentina rallied for a 2-1 victory over England in the World Cup semifinals. **C1.**

Hazy, crazy

Thursday: Hazy and hot. High: 89-94. Low: 65-70.

Friday: Mostly sunny. High: 85-90. Low: 64-69. Sunrise: 5:21 Sunset: 8:19 Comics and Weather, **D5-6.** Obituaries, **C9.**

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Still few details on death of cyclist

Even a week later, officials offer little about fatal crash

By Sean Cotter
GLOBE STAFF

After a truck struck and killed cyclist Louisa Gag, the outpouring of grief was immediate from scores of friends, fellow activists, and City Hall co-workers — including Mayor Michelle Wu, for whom Gag had been an intern years ago.

But a week later, there is still very little known about the circumstances of her death.

City Hall remains reticent about details: How the crash happened, the name of the driver, and owner of the vehicle are among the major facts that remain undisclosed. Meanwhile, transit activists who knew Gag continue to criticize Wu, questioning her administration's recent steps to remove protective barriers from some bike lanes and slow-walk other projects, as well as the lack of progress on its own plans for safety improvements near the intersection with Tremont Street where their friend died.

In response to multiple questions on Wednesday morning, Wu deferred to the ongoing investigation, saying she didn't want to release any information that could jeopardize it.

"We need a full, transparent, comprehensive investigation about the facts of exactly what took place and what needs to be done to make sure that this never happens again," Wu told reporters. **CYCLIST, Page A10**

'I think it's important that we support candidates who are in the fight to lower costs for American families. . . . And that's what I'm going to keep right on doing.'

SENATOR ELIZABETH WARREN

Warren pushing primary picks, but several stumble

Platner collapse highlights risks of endorsements

By Sam Brodey
GLOBE STAFF

Ahead of the 2026 midterm elections, Massachusetts Senator Elizabeth Warren has sought to put her political muscle into action by elevating Democratic candidates nationwide who share her progressive populist vision.

So far, it's not going the way she hoped.

Several of the most high-profile candidates backed by Warren have been busted, either by losing in their primaries or ending their campaigns early.

Perhaps her most prominent candidate, former Maine Senate nominee Graham Platner, collapsed so disastrously that it could boomerang on Warren and other notable Democrats who vocally championed him.

Last week, Platner ended his campaign in the wake of sexual assault allegations — throwing the must-win Maine race into chaos and sparking fierce recriminations within the party. **WARREN, Page A6**

Area beaches among cleanest, but still not always open

Overwhelmed storm and sewer drain systems largely to blame

By Audrey Tomlin
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

LYNN — Growing up here, state Senator Brendan Crighton doesn't remember visiting the city's only sand beach.

For as long as he can recall, people in Lynn knew King's Beach was often not safe for swimming. Then last summer, for the first time, Crighton swam at King's Beach with his two children, ages 6 and 10.

King's still experiences high bacteria levels, experts and advocates warned. But for an urban beach long notorious for its pollution, it has come a far way: Last year, King's Beach passed 90 percent of water

quality tests, after posting much lower results in the preceding years.

That progress is broadly reflected throughout the Boston area as the region ranked as having some of the cleanest metropolitan beaches in the United States last year, according to the most recent annual report from Save the Harbor/Save the Bay, a nonprofit that's advocated for the cleanup of Boston Harbor and Massachusetts Bay since 1986.

Last year was the first that every urban beach in Greater Boston passed more than 80 percent of the Department of Environmental Protection's



JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

A woman walked past King's Beach in Lynn as a no swimming flag flapped in the breeze in June. **BEACHES, Page B4**